

VOICE-OVER RECORDING SCRIPT

One voice. 31 lines, about 256 words, across three minutes. The sparseness is deliberate – the film's argument is carried by music and by a number on screen driven by real crowd telemetry. The long silences are written in, not gaps waiting to be filled.

The speaker is the antagonist: the author of the argument for turning celebration down to a safe level. He is narrating in retrospect, to someone he assumes agrees with him, and he believes he is the reasonable party.

SMUG, NOT JACKBOOTED. Warm, unhurried, faintly amused, completely certain. Never angry, never menacing, never camp. A senior public-health official who is pleased to explain something to you and has never been contradicted. The film only works if his case genuinely lands.

Record dry: 48kHz 24-bit mono WAV, no processing of any kind. One file per line, named by its number. Three reads of each – as written, warmer, drier – in the same file. Plus thirty seconds of clean room tone as its own file.

ACT I	THE CLOSED FILE	0:00–0:35	5 lines
ACT II	THE MOONSHOT	0:35–1:05	6 lines
ACT III	IT WORKS, AND HE ARRIVES	1:05–1:35	6 lines
ACT IV	THE SQUEEZE	1:35–2:24	9 lines
ACT V	THE ANSWER	2:24–3:00	5 lines

ACT I – THE CLOSED FILE 0:00–0:35

A1 0:01.5 It is quiet now. We made it quiet.

Opening the film. Almost pleasant, and he takes the credit in the second sentence – the audience knows who did this before they know what it is. Past tense from the first word: he is already on the other side of it.

B1 0:05.5 They play the moon landing all day. To prove it is over.

Over 1969 on a CRT nobody watches. She is reading the official meaning off an image, flatly, the way you would read a plaque. Sets up the last line of the film.

0:10.5–0:14.5 – silence –

The power notice. The panel reads itself; do not talk over it.

A2 0:14.9 We already did the big thing. So nobody needs much power.

The whole argument of the film, in eleven plain words. Flat – a statement of policy, not a defence. Everything he does later follows from this one sentence, so it has to be completely clear and completely calm.

A3 0:19.5 I wrote the rules.

He is on screen. Not boastful. A small, satisfied fact – and it tells the audience he is not a guard, he is the author.

B4 0:30.5 But the moon still pulls the sea. For free.

The hook. Over an airliner crossing the moon while nobody looks up. "But" is load-bearing: it is the first push back in the film. She has turned a closed file into a free power source. An engineer spotting something on a balance sheet, not poetry. The flatter it is read, the bigger it gets.

ACT II – THE MOONSHOT 0:35–1:05

B5 0:36.0 We have no power. So we are building a machine out of people.

Over the lab going dark. Two old lines welded into one, because "we have no machines" was a step the audience takes for itself the moment they see the lab go dark. The "so" is the whole sentence: it makes the plan a consequence rather than an idea. Present tense, matter of fact, and said as though it were the obvious next step, because to her it is.

B7 0:42.1 The bands read breath and pulse. Three hundred people moving as one.

A parts list, and the one line that says what the apparatus actually does. The headbands are on screen through the whole ritual and until now nothing named them, which left the room looking like a rite instead of an instrument. Technical, unhurried, quietly pleased with how neat it is. No mysticism whatsoever.

B8 0:47.5 Together they make one signal.

The ritual as engineering, and it is now four words shorter because the second half – "and we know where to point it" – was saying what the very next shot shows. The cut lands on "signal": the exterior, beams leaving the roof and converging on the moon, at 0:49.9. This is the shot the film is named after, and the line hands it over rather than narrating it.

B9 0:54.3 The number has to stay above eighty. That is the whole plan.

The most load-bearing line in the film. It hands the audience the scoreboard, and it names the thing in the corner of the frame so they know what to watch. Read it as a spec, not a challenge – she is stating a target, not making a vow. Everything after this is suspense only because this line is clear, so give it air.

ACT II – THE MOONSHOT 0:35–1:05

A4 0:59.6 They still get together. I think that is sweet.

Genuinely warm. No irony on "sweet". He has just heard the entire plan and understood none of it.

B10 1:03.4 It locks. Something answers.

Over the readout waking, on the SIGNAL STRENGTH card. Four words, and the second half of the mechanism: B7 said what the bands read, this says what happens when the room comes into phase. "Locks" is the engineering word and it is the only one she needs. The first hint that anybody is out there – reported as a result, not a revelation.

ACT III – IT WORKS, AND HE ARRIVES 1:05–1:35

A5 1:06.0 Look at them. Really – look.

An invitation. He thinks he is showing you evidence.

1:09.1–1:13.5 – silence –

Blood moon, then the transformation. Nothing over it.

B11 1:14.0 It is changing us first.

This is what explains the beasts. An observation about a side effect she had not expected and does not regret. Three words, and the picture has just shown you what she means.

B12 1:17.5 That is the cost. You do not stay the same shape.

Flat, almost a technical footnote. The most frightening line she has, and only if it is read with no drama at all.

A6 1:22.6 Ninety-six decibels. Over the limit.

Purely administrative, and it states the rule he is about to enforce. The coldest line in the film and it must be the dullest. Sits inside the meter shot either way; nudged earlier so it clears B13, which is pinned to the 79.9 on screen and cannot move.

B13 1:26.0 Seventy-nine point nine. Hold it there.

The number on screen reads 79.9 as she says it, and it never gets higher before the attack. She is one tenth short and she does not know that is as close as they will come. Do not play the disappointment – she still thinks they will get there. The audience does the ache.

B14 1:29.4 Someone at the door is measuring us.

The two halves of the film touch for the first time. Not alarm – she has noticed something and is reporting it while she works. The audience is far more worried than she is.

ACT IV – THE SQUEEZE 1:35–2:24

- A7** 1:36.6 And no one could tell me what it was for.
He was told, and did not listen – the audience has known since 0:54. On screen at the peak. Faint irritation, quickly controlled. In a finished world nothing **can** be for anything, so to him the question is sincere.
- A8** 1:41.6 We were like you once. We burned bright too.
Warmest line in the film. He is holding up his own book, offering his own life as proof he understands.
- B16** 1:45.8 They are not stopping the party. Just the number.
Over the readout being forced down. The thriller line, and now it says exactly what the attack is – he is not banning anything, he is deleting the evidence. Cold and clear, and slightly too late.
- A9** 1:50.0 You are not having fun. Your own machine says so.
Said kindly, the way a doctor breaks bad news gently. Devastating precisely because it is not cruel. Opens on its card.
- A10** 1:54.6 They kept dancing in the dark. We did not plan for that.
The one place the mask slips. He treated them as people who use electricity; they are not, which is the entire point of the ritual – he has cut the power to a machine that does not run on power. First sentence an observation, second a man reaching for flat official language to cover a hole in his sums. Let the last sentence sit slightly apart.

ACT IV – THE SQUEEZE 1:35–2:24

B17 1:59.9 It is coming back. Do not stop.

The cruellest placement in the film. The number really is climbing – 52 and rising – and she is urging the room on about one second before the breaker kills it. Play it as work, not triumph: she is calling out a reading and giving an instruction. She has no idea.

A11 2:03.3 So we cut the power.

Over the aftermath of the breaker. Absolutely neutral, and it answers her line directly without either of them knowing. Plain words make it worse, not softer.

A12 2:09.3 It is not cruel. It is just math.

Over the screens dying. Calm and, to him, obviously true – and it is true, which is the confession.

B18 2:15.0 Zero. We think we killed it.

The screen reads 0.0. The bottom of the film, and the only line where she is not quite in control – audible as a slight flattening, nothing more. Note the tense: she still does not know.

2:19.4–2:24.4 – silence –

The aftermath. Five seconds, no voice, almost no score. Do not fill this.

ACT V — THE ANSWER 2:24–3:00

A13 2:24.8 There was nothing left. I checked.

The number crosses eighty for the first time in the entire film four tenths of a second before he says this, and the picture under him is a beast's hand pushing the dome's plug back into the socket while the lights come up. Total confidence, contradicted twice in the same second — by the corner of his own frame and by the shot he is talking over.

2:28.4–2:38.4 — silence —

Ten seconds, and the longest hold in the film. It picks up a second into THE TURN and runs through the rest of it and all of the moon with an eye. There was a line here once, "It did not die. It is holding us up now.", and it was saying in words what two shots were already saying in pictures. The film answers with pictures. Do not fill this — C4 lands on the far side of it, a second into the shot after, not inside it.

B20 2:42.2 Over eighty. It is holding.

The screen reads 85.0. The target from 0:54, cleared — the line the whole film has been waiting for, and it should be read as plainly as the reading at 1:26. The audience supplies the elation.

B21 2:44.8 We woke something up. And it came back for us.

Over the room itself — three hundred people on the venue's own camera at ten to three in the morning, the date burned into the corner, and the only shot in the film that is simply the thing the argument is about. It used to play over a moon dance off the contest edit, which showed a crowd at one remove. "It came back for us" is a different sentence when *us* is on screen. The bond — the actual moonshot. Not triumph. Closer to being met.

ACT V – THE ANSWER 2:24–3:00

A14 2:49.4 We will need to do something about the moon.

His last line, and he has learned nothing – the logic does not stop, it moves up a scale. It lands *inside* the card where the machine picks a side, so he files a note about the moon while the thing commits behind him. Read exactly like A2: a small administrative note to himself. No wink. Funnier and worse if he means it.

2:53.2–2:55.1 – silence –

The rest of the sign-on, and the van. The machine changing sides is a signature, not an argument; nobody narrates it.

B22 2:55.1 They said it was behind us. It is ahead of us.

The last line of the film, over the title, answering B1 word for word. Flat and certain. Not a rallying cry – a correction to the record.